

Infinix ZeroBook 13

More power, less price but what's the catch?

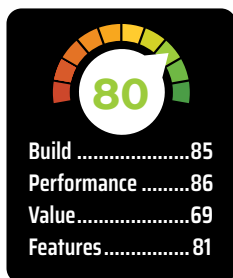
You might not know this but Infinix is a brand that's really killing it in the laptop game! For instance, the Infinix Inbook x1 Slim, the Y1 Plus, and many more offer really good value for money for budget buyers! But what about high-end users? Well, Infinix has something for them as well. The Infinix ZeroBook is an Intel Core i9-powered laptop that's really capable of a wide variety of demanding tasks.

My colleague had previously reviewed the Intel 12th gen variant of the ZeroBook sometime ago and it was pretty impressive. In fact, it was one of the most affordable Core i9-powered laptops with some serious performance. And today we have the 13th gen variant of the Infinix ZeroBook so we will try to find out what all changed, what all remains the same, and most importantly, whether is it a good deal for you or not!

DESIGN, KEYBOARD AND TRACKPAD

Now if you've been paying attention until now, you might have noticed that both the 13th Gen and the 12th gen variant of the ZeroBook look almost identical! Both have the same keyboard, the same trackpad, the same I/O ports and also the same screen size! Even the charger is identical.

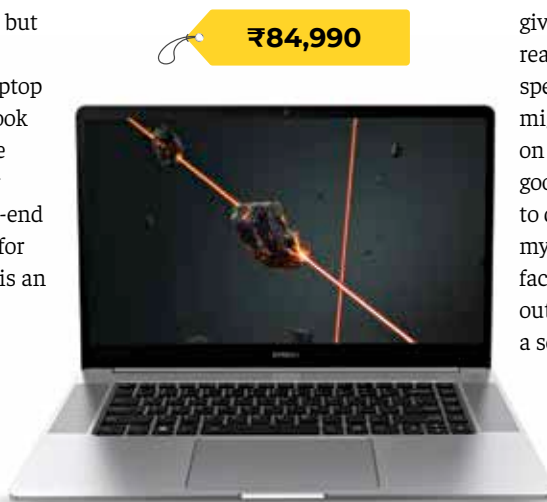
But don't let this fool you because there are differences. Firstly, the hinge feels a lot smoother in this variant. Like if you try to open the laptop's lid on the previous version, you will at some point end up lifting it up from the base, but in this variant you can easily lift the lid and the laptop will stay in its place! And the second difference is in terms of



performance, about which I'll tell you a bit later in the article.

Visually, the Infinix ZeroBook Ultra will remind you of a MacBook but with some minor differences. Like, the trackpad, despite the laptop being a 15.6-inch in size, still is relatively small. Because if we're comparing it with a MacBook, you can see side by side, how big the trackpad on the latter is. But in functionality it works well. Try clicking on either the left or the right side and the ZeroBook's trackpad will be pressed down at an equal level. That is to say, the trackpad is installed with high precision.

I have similar issues with the keyboard too, the keys feel a little bit cramped for a laptop of this size. Just take a look at how it compared to an HP Envy 15, one of the upcoming laptops, and you'll see the difference more clearly. The keys have good travel and even the laptop's chassis is pretty solid to make for a good typing experience. But it is just that the keys themselves are a bit small.



One of the reasons why the keyboard is like that is because of Infinix's decision to place the speaker grille right next to the keyboard. Now, I love upward firing speaker grille more than MS Dhoni loves expanding his motorcycle collection. But if Infinix has already gives us upward firing speakers, there really was no need to put two additional speaker grille under the laptop. Now I might think that I can place this laptop on my bed and watch movies with a good sound output but I won't be able to do that because the soft surface of my bed would cover up the downward facing speaker. Mind you, the speaker output is great if you keep the laptop on a solid surface.

The I/O port selection is identical to the previous generation and so is the "ZeroBook" engraving on the laptop's lid along with some additional etching all around it.

One sort of visual carry over from previous generation is that when you put the laptop in "Over Boost" mode a red light starts to glow under the hinge. So overall, the build is quiet solid and boasts some improvements but still this design has some quirks to iron out.

DISPLAY

Also carried over from the last year in the Infinix ZeroBook Ultra is the same 15.6-inch FHD 60Hz "glossy" display. In Digi's display test I found the screen to be almost identical to the previous generation and it is a good thing. Mainly because last year's ZeroBook display had good brightness and punchy colours.

It is not the most colour accurate display of the bunch but it is great for watching movies, scrolling through web or watching YouTube. I'd rather not recommend you perform colour grading using this display particularly due to low DCI-P3 coverage and a not so colour accurate colour projection. Now, it is not as inaccurate as PC gamers thinking the problem with gaming industry will solve itself out even if they don't stop pre-ordering videogames, but I'd still not recommend it for professional grade colour grading.